

CAPITAL CORE

Business Strategy & Growth • Investment & Markets

THE CONCEPT

Capital Core is a live, zero-day challenge in which participants make real-world business and financial decisions under pressure. The actual problem is revealed on the event day; teams must analyse the situation, build a defensible response and pitch it.

TWO CATEGORIES

01 BUSINESS STRATEGY & GROWTH

GRADES 6–8 • HUMAN ONLY

Live business challenge focused on strategy, growth and decision-making.

02 INVESTMENT & MARKETS

GRADES 9–10 • AI PERMITTED • PROMPT LOG REQUIRED

Live finance challenge focused on markets, investment decisions and risk.

CORE REQUIREMENTS

DEVICE COMPULSORY

Bring a charged personal device.

ZERO-DAY

Actual problem drops live on the event day.

JUNIOR POLICY

Human-only strategy and decision-making.

SENIOR AI POLICY

AI permitted with mandatory prompt log.

THE DROP → THE ANALYSE → THE DECIDE → THE PITCH

The following briefs are sample problems only. The actual Capital Core challenge is revealed on the day.

BUSINESS STRATEGY & GROWTH

GRADES 6–8 • HUMAN ONLY

Sample briefs illustrate the level and style of the junior challenge. They are not the actual zero-day questions.

01 THE AFTER-4 PM CAFÉ

A neighbourhood café has plenty of customers on weekends but very few after 4 PM on weekdays. The owner cannot afford major renovations or expensive advertising. Create a strategy to increase weekday afternoon customers using the café's existing resources.

02 THE EMPTY CINEMA

A local cinema regularly has large numbers of empty seats on weekday afternoon shows even though the same films sell out on weekends. Create a pricing and promotion strategy that increases weekday attendance without unnecessarily reducing weekend ticket revenue.

03 THE SPORTS SHOP

A sports shop near a school sells expensive equipment but receives most of its sales only at the beginning of the academic year. Create a strategy that generates more regular customers throughout the year without relying on heavy discounts.

INVESTMENT & MARKETS

GRADES 9–10 • AI PERMITTED • PROMPT LOG REQUIRED

Sample briefs illustrate the level and style of the senior challenge. They are not the actual zero-day questions.

01 THE 5 LAKH PORTFOLIO

You have 5 lakhs to invest for a five-year goal. You can divide the money between a broad equity index fund, government bonds, gold and a fixed deposit. Using the supplied historical data, construct a portfolio and justify how your allocation balances expected return and risk.

02 THE FALLING STOCK

You own shares in a company whose price has fallen 25% after disappointing quarterly results. The company's revenue is still growing, but profit margins have declined and its competitors are gaining market share. Decide whether to hold, sell or buy more shares and justify the decision.

03 THE 2 CRORE EXPANSION

A startup developing an AI-powered education platform needs 2 crores to expand. It can accept investment from a venture capital firm, take a business loan or delay expansion and grow using its current revenue. Compare the financial consequences of each option and recommend one.

THE ZERO-DAY

JUNIOR HUMAN ONLY • SENIOR AI PERMITTED

01 THE DROP

The actual Capital Core problem is revealed live on the event day. No pre-made response is required.

02 THE ANALYSE

Identify the real business or financial problem, separate constraints from assumptions, and use the information supplied.

03 THE DECIDE

Compare realistic options, consider trade-offs and choose a strategy or financial decision that can be defended.

04 THE PITCH

Present the recommendation clearly and defend why it is stronger than the alternatives.

05 SENIOR AI ADVANTAGE

For Investment & Markets, AI is permitted. Participants must submit their prompt history and critically verify and refine AI-assisted work.

CAPITAL CORE

The numbers may change. The businesses may change. The market may change. The challenge is whether your decision still makes sense.